

Google-Firefox deal extended

Google has extended the search deal with Mozilla for the Firefox browser, by another three years

Google's search results history

A short history of the evolution of search, highlighting some important milestones <http://bit.ly/tLnjWs>

Tablet test



Samsung Galaxy Tab 750

some class from a tablet that is quite expensive. Performance-wise, this one doesn't seem to witness any slowdowns, even with multiple apps open in the background. The TouchWiz UI doesn't really add any features, except minor eye candy. The dock at the bottom of the display reminds us of the Apple vs. Samsung lawsuits! Having said that, the Tab 750's display is an all rounder – handles videos, text and web browsing with equal aplomb. In a nutshell, the Tab 750 may not be the flamboyant alternative to the iPad anymore, but is a very competitive Android tablet nevertheless.

Whether this is a master-stroke, or an absolute disaster, only time will tell. But the Asus Eee Pad Slider does bring a combo to the table that will appeal to the demographic that can't do without a hardware keypad while typing mails and messages. Slightly pricey admit-



Asus Eee Pad Slider

tedly, it seems like a poorer cousin of the Eee Pad Transformer – with a smaller battery (despite the same screen size) and an older version of Android (still stuck on Android 3.1). Performance-wise,

the Transformer again takes the lead. The Slider's build quality is quite solid, but seems to have a bit of roughness about it. The pop-out keypad's mechanism is hard at best. The materials used give it a dull aura. While this one looks like a unique package, the Transformer is a better (and a lower priced) alternative. Even more so, if you find the "dock included free" deal.

Motorola's Xoom now feels old, and there's no getting around that fact. At the turn of 2011, the Xoom was the snazziest of all Android tablets that seemed to be rolling out by the dozen. However, about 12 months later, the Xoom feels heavy, the UI isn't unique anymore and other tablets offer better battery life. Credit where it is due, though: the Xoom still doesn't feel outdated as far as performance is concerned. It didn't score very highly in our performance tests, but was a solid mid-field runner.



Motorola Xoom

controls with an iron fist has worked well. The performance is unparalleled, as the benchmark scores prove, and it has by far the best battery life across the table. And it does all that while keeping itself slim and looking stunning. Drawbacks are there though – it's tied to iTunes, limited native video codec support and some apps that are free on Android are paid on the iOS platform. But the sheer volume and variety of accessories proves the fact that this device is very well supported. We believe this offers the best performance package. Android has to try all over again in 2012.

Our Best Buy goes to the Asus Eee Pad Transformer which is a unique proof-of-concept, marrying

the elements of a tablet with a netbook. The result is quite simply a one-of-a-kind experience that other tablets don't provide and can't match right now.

What to expect in the coming year?

Well, expect the tablet bar to be raised considerably with the iPad 3. The current 9.7-inch version will definitely be upgraded with the same display size. Rumours are strong about a 7-inch version as well, but we'll take that with a pinch of salt at the moment. Android's assault should continue, but will totally depend on whether the tablets can catch up to the sheer performance advantage that the iPads seem to have at the moment. RIM has confirmed that we'll see version 2.0 of its Tablet OS in the first quarter, bringing a native email client and possibly even BBM. Whether that revives RIM's fortunes depends on how much of an upgrade that upgrade is! Microsoft will unleash its tablet OS later this year, so expect Windows 8 on the tablet roadmap.

We're hearing that Nokia and Samsung will be



Apple iPad 2 (Wi-Fi + 3G)

launching Windows 8 based tablets post June 2012. That should shake up the market nicely. **d**